Crowbar Evaltree Insights

Startup Valuation — 2026 Edition

Digital Intelligence Product — Licensed, Not Sold

For informational purposes only. Not investment, legal, financial, or strategic advice.

GLOBAL DISCLAIMER

This intelligence brief is provided for educational and informational purposes only. It does not constitute investment, legal, financial, tax, or regulated advice. Use at your own discretion. Digital Product — Licensed for personal use only. Redistribution prohibited.

PRIVACY & CONFIDENTIALITY NOTICE

This document contains no personal data. Purchase details are processed under GDPR, CCPA, and India DPDP. Crowbar Ventures Limited does not store personal information within this document.

SOURCES & REFERENCES POLICY

Sources used are considered reliable but not independently verified. No warranty is made regarding accuracy or completeness.

LEGAL DISCLAIMER

This brief is not investment, financial, valuation, legal, tax, accounting, or strategic advice. Readers should consult professionals.

JURISDICTION NOTICES

EU/UK: Not investment research. US: Not financial guidance. India: Not investment advice. UAE: Not solicitation. Singapore: Not regulated research.

LICENSING & USAGE RIGHTS

Licensed for personal use only. Non-transferable. Redistribution or public posting prohibited.

Executive Summary

Startup valuation in 2025 refers to the process by which investors and founders assign monetary value to early-stage companies with limited financial history and uncertain future outcomes. Valuation determines ownership allocation during fundraising and establishes benchmarks for subsequent financing rounds.

The valuation logic used in 2025 differs from prior cycles due to shifts in capital availability, interest rate environments, and exit market conditions. The period from 2020 to 2021 saw inflated valuations driven by low interest rates and abundant venture capital. The correction that began in 2022 continued through 2024, establishing new expectations around revenue multiples, growth rates, and profitability timelines.

Key valuation frameworks currently in use include revenue multiples benchmarked to comparable public companies, stage-specific heuristics based on traction and market position, and discounted cash flow models applied selectively to later-stage companies with predictable unit economics. Investors in 2025 emphasize capital efficiency, path to profitability, and risk-adjusted returns in a higher interest rate environment.

This brief documents the dominant valuation practices observed in 2025, the assumptions embedded in those practices, and the market conditions that shape current investor expectations. It takes no position on whether these frameworks produce accurate valuations.

What Startup Valuation Is (Plain English)

Startup valuation is the estimated monetary worth of a company at a specific point in time, typically determined during a fundraising event. The valuation establishes how much equity founders must exchange for investor capital.

What valuation represents

Valuation is a negotiated outcome reflecting investor expectations of future returns, perceived risk, competitive dynamics among investors, and founder leverage. It is not an objective measure of intrinsic worth. Two investors may assign different valuations to the same company based on different return requirements, risk tolerances, or strategic interests.

Pre-money valuation refers to the company's value before new capital is invested. Post-money valuation includes the new capital. If a company raises $10 million at a $40 million pre-money valuation, the post-money valuation is $50 million, and the investor owns 20 percent.

What valuation does not represent

Valuation is not the price at which the company could be sold immediately. Most startup valuations exceed what acquirers would pay at the time of investment. Valuation does not guarantee future outcomes. Companies valued at $100 million may fail or achieve billion-dollar exits.

Valuation is not static. Subsequent rounds may occur at higher valuations (up rounds), the same valuation (flat rounds), or lower valuations (down rounds). Down rounds reset ownership structures and can dilute earlier investors and founders.

Common misunderstandings

Many founders conflate high valuations with success. A high valuation that requires excessive dilution or unsustainable growth expectations may harm long-term outcomes. Valuation must be considered alongside other deal terms, including liquidation preferences, board composition, and investor rights.

Valuation is often misunderstood as a precise calculation. In reality, it is a forward-looking estimate based on assumptions that may not materialize. Early-stage valuations rely heavily on qualitative judgments about market opportunity, team quality, and competitive positioning.

Dominant Valuation Frameworks in 2025

Investors in 2025 use multiple frameworks depending on company stage, sector, and available financial data. The following methods are most commonly referenced in public investor commentary and market data.

Revenue-Based Approaches

Revenue multiples are the most widely used valuation method for startups with established revenue streams. The valuation is calculated by multiplying annual recurring revenue or forward revenue by a sector-specific multiple.

PitchBook reported that median revenue multiples for late-stage venture deals in the United States declined from approximately 20x in 2021 to approximately 8x by mid-2024 (PitchBook Q2 2024 US Venture Valuations Report, https://pitchbook.com/news/reports/q2-2024-us-venture-valuations-report). Public market multiples for software companies, often used as reference points, compressed significantly during the same period.

Revenue multiples vary by growth rate, margin profile, market size, and competitive intensity. Software-as-a-service companies with annual recurring revenue growth above 100 percent and gross margins above 70 percent command higher multiples than companies with slower growth or lower margins. Bessemer Venture Partners' State of the Cloud report, published annually, provides benchmark multiples for public SaaS companies (Bessemer Venture Partners, "State of the Cloud 2024", https://www.bvp.com/atlas/state-of-the-cloud-2024).

Revenue multiples are less applicable to pre-revenue companies or businesses with one-time transaction revenue rather than recurring revenue.

Market Multiple References

Investors frequently reference comparable company valuations to justify or challenge proposed valuations. Comparables may include public companies, recently funded private companies, or acquisition transactions.

Public company multiples are adjusted downward to account for illiquidity and risk in private markets. A typical illiquidity discount ranges from 20 to 40 percent, though this is not a fixed rule. The size and direction of the discount depends on market conditions and sector (NYU Stern Valuation Research, https://pages.stern.nyu.edu/~adamodar/).

Comparables are most useful when close analogs exist. Investors evaluate revenue model similarity, market positioning, growth trajectory, and unit economics. However, true comparables are rare, particularly for early-stage companies operating in emerging categories.

Discounted Cash Flow Usage

Discounted cash flow models project future cash flows and discount them to present value using a risk-adjusted discount rate. This method is used selectively in venture capital, primarily for later-stage companies with predictable financial performance.

The discount rate reflects the investor's required rate of return, which depends on perceived risk. Venture capital discount rates typically range from 30 to 60 percent for early-stage companies, declining as companies mature and de-risk (Harvard Business School, "Note on Valuation of Venture Capital Deals", https://www.hbs.edu/faculty/Pages/item.aspx?num=41038).

DCF models are less common for seed and Series A companies because cash flow projections are highly uncertain. Investors at these stages rely more on market multiples and heuristics.

Comparable Company Logic

Investors use recent funding rounds of similar companies as valuation anchors. If a competitor raised capital at a $100 million valuation with similar revenue and growth metrics, investors may use that as a starting point for negotiation.

This approach assumes that the comparable company's valuation was efficiently priced, which may not be true. Valuation trends can overshoot or undershoot fundamentals, particularly during periods of capital abundance or scarcity.

CB Insights and Crunchbase publish data on funding rounds, valuations, and deal terms, which investors and founders use to benchmark (CB Insights, https://www.cbinsights.com; Crunchbase, https://www.crunchbase.com).

Stage-Specific Heuristics

At seed stage, valuations are often determined by standard deal structures rather than financial metrics. In 2025, typical seed valuations in the United States range from $5 million to $15 million post-money, depending on team pedigree, market opportunity, and competitive dynamics (AngelList data, https://www.angellist.com).

Series A valuations depend on demonstrated product-market fit, measured by revenue traction, user growth, or engagement metrics. Carta reported that median Series A valuations in the United States in 2024 ranged from $30 million to $60 million post-money (Carta, "Equity Report Q3 2024", https://carta.com/equity).

Series B and later rounds increasingly emphasize unit economics, retention metrics, and capital efficiency. Investors expect clear paths to profitability within defined time horizons.

The Dominant Logic at the Time

The prevailing valuation logic in 2025 is shaped by macroeconomic conditions, investor return expectations, and observed market outcomes from prior cycles.

Assumptions Most Investors Operate Under

Higher cost of capital justifies lower multiples. Federal Reserve interest rate increases beginning in 2022 raised the risk-free rate of return. Investors compare venture capital returns to alternative assets such as treasury bonds or money market funds. When risk-free rates exceeded 5 percent in 2023-2024, venture capital investments required higher expected returns to justify the risk premium (Federal Reserve Economic Data, https://fred.stlouisfed.org).

Higher discount rates reduce the present value of future cash flows, lowering justified valuations. This logic applies across asset classes and is not specific to venture capital.

Profitability timelines have shortened. Investors in 2025 expect companies to demonstrate paths to profitability within three to five years, compared to longer timelines accepted in prior cycles. This reflects reduced tolerance for capital-intensive growth strategies that rely on future funding availability.

Silicon Valley Bank's State of Venture reports document this shift, noting increased emphasis on unit economics and burn rate management (SVB, "State of the Markets Q1 2024", https://www.svb.com/trends-insights/reports/startup-outlook-report).

Growth alone is insufficient. Revenue growth rates above 100 percent were sufficient to command premium valuations in 2020-2021. In 2025, investors additionally evaluate gross margin, customer acquisition cost payback periods, net revenue retention, and cash flow efficiency. Companies that grow inefficiently face valuation discounts.

This shift reflects lessons from the 2022-2024 correction, during which unprofitable high-growth companies experienced severe valuation declines in public markets.

Exit multiples are compressed. Public market exit valuations declined significantly from 2021 peaks. Software companies trading at 20-30x revenue in 2021 traded at 5-10x revenue by 2024 (Bessemer Venture Partners, "State of the Cloud 2024", https://www.bvp.com/atlas/state-of-the-cloud-2024). M&A exit valuations followed similar trends.

Investors model exit scenarios using current market multiples rather than historical peaks, resulting in lower implied valuations for private companies.

Capital efficiency is rewarded. Companies that achieve milestones with less capital dilute less and generate higher returns for early investors. Investors in 2025 favor teams that demonstrate resourcefulness and operational discipline.

This preference is documented in investor surveys and public statements from prominent venture capital firms, including Sequoia Capital's "Crucible Moment" memo (September 2022) and Y Combinator's guidance to founders on extending runway (Y Combinator blog, https://www.ycombinator.com/blog).

How Macro Conditions Shape Valuation Expectations

Interest rate policy directly affects venture capital valuations through discount rates and alternative investment returns. The Federal Reserve raised rates from near-zero in 2021 to above 5 percent by 2023, the fastest tightening cycle in decades (Federal Reserve FOMC statements, https://www.federalreserve.gov).

Capital flows into venture capital declined following public market corrections. According to PitchBook, US venture capital investment volumes fell from $344 billion in 2021 to $171 billion in 2023 (PitchBook-NVCA Venture Monitor Q4 2023, https://pitchbook.com). Reduced capital availability increased investor selectivity and lowered valuations.

IPO markets largely closed for unprofitable companies in 2022-2024. The number of venture-backed IPOs in the United States declined from 102 in 2021 to 20 in 2023 (Renaissance Capital IPO data, https://www.renaissancecapital.com). Limited exit opportunities reduce investor willingness to deploy capital at high valuations.

Why These Assumptions Appear Internally Consistent

The current valuation framework reflects rational responses to changed conditions. Higher interest rates increase opportunity costs of capital. Compressed public market multiples lower exit values. Reduced IPO activity extends time to liquidity. These factors logically lead to lower private valuations and greater emphasis on capital efficiency.

Investors who maintained 2021 valuation expectations would generate below-market returns given current exit environment. The observed valuation compression represents a market correction toward levels more consistent with prevailing macro conditions.

This does not mean current valuations are "correct" in an absolute sense. Future changes in interest rates, exit markets, or growth trajectories could shift valuations upward or downward. The current framework reflects equilibrium expectations given available information.

Factors Currently Influencing Valuations

Multiple factors affect startup valuations in 2025. The following are documented in market data and investor commentary.

Capital Availability

Venture capital fundraising declined in 2022-2024. According to PitchBook, US venture capital firms raised $67 billion in 2023, down from $162 billion in 2021 (PitchBook-NVCA Venture Monitor, https://pitchbook.com). Fewer dollars chasing deals creates downward pressure on valuations.

Mega-funds raised by firms such as Sequoia Capital, Andreessen Horowitz, and Tiger Global during 2020-2021 deployed capital throughout 2022-2024, providing liquidity to the market. However, these funds became more selective, focusing on proven business models and later-stage opportunities.

Seed and Series A capital remained relatively available compared to growth-stage capital. Early-stage investors continued to deploy capital but at more disciplined valuations (NVCA Yearbook 2024, https://nvca.org/research/nvca-yearbook/).

Interest Rates

As discussed previously, interest rates directly affect discount rates used in valuation models. The Federal Reserve's target rate remained elevated through 2024, maintaining pressure on valuations (Federal Reserve FOMC statements, https://www.federalreserve.gov).

Market expectations for future rate cuts influence investor behavior. If rates are expected to decline, investors may accept current valuations anticipating future multiple expansion. If rates are expected to remain elevated, valuation pressure persists.

Exit Environment

Exit opportunities shape investor willingness to deploy capital and acceptable valuation levels. IPO markets showed limited recovery in 2024. According to Renaissance Capital, venture-backed IPO activity remained below historical averages (Renaissance Capital IPO data, https://www.renaissancecapital.com).

M&A activity also declined. PwC reported that global M&A deal values in technology sectors fell significantly from 2021 peaks (PwC Global M&A Trends, https://www.pwc.com/us/en/services/consulting/deals/library/global-ma-industry-trends.html).

Strategic acquirers faced their own valuation pressures and became more cautious. Financial acquirers (private equity firms) focused on profitable, cash-generative businesses rather than high-growth unprofitable companies.

Sector Concentration

Certain sectors commanded premium valuations in 2025 due to structural tailwinds or investor conviction. Artificial intelligence and machine learning companies attracted significant capital following the release of ChatGPT in late 2022 and subsequent adoption of generative AI technologies.

PitchBook reported that AI-related venture capital investments grew substantially in 2023-2024, with median valuations exceeding other software categories (PitchBook "Emerging Tech Research: Generative AI", https://pitchbook.com). However, valuations within AI varied significantly based on differentiation, customer traction, and competitive positioning.

Climate tech, infrastructure software, and cybersecurity also attracted above-average investor interest. Consumer software and e-commerce faced more challenging valuation environments due to slower growth and competitive saturation.

Geography Effects

Valuations vary significantly by geography. US companies typically achieve higher valuations than European or Asian companies at comparable stages, reflecting larger addressable markets, more liquid exit opportunities, and greater capital availability.

Atomico's State of European Tech report documents persistent valuation gaps between US and European startups (Atomico, "State of European Tech 2024", https://www.atomico.com/reports). Indian startups faced valuation corrections in 2022-2023 following a period of rapid growth in 2020-2021 (Bain & Company India Venture Capital Report 2024, https://www.bain.com).

These geographic differences reflect structural factors including market size, regulatory environments, and investor ecosystems, not fundamental differences in company quality.

What Investors Publicly Say vs What Data Shows

Investor commentary and observable outcomes sometimes diverge. The following compares stated investment criteria with documented behavior.

Stated Criteria

Prominent venture capital firms publish investment theses and selection criteria. Common themes in 2025 include emphasis on large addressable markets, differentiated technology or business models, experienced founding teams, demonstrated traction, and capital efficiency.

Sequoia Capital's investment criteria emphasize clarity of purpose, market insight, and enduring advantages (Sequoia Capital website, https://www.sequoiaap.com). Andreessen Horowitz describes focus on technical founders building transformative companies (a16z website, https://a16z.com).

Investor surveys published by NVCA and other industry groups indicate that team quality remains the most frequently cited factor in investment decisions (NVCA membership surveys, https://nvca.org).

Observable Valuation Outcomes

Market data reveals patterns that may not align perfectly with stated criteria. PitchBook data shows that founders with prior successful exits command significant valuation premiums compared to first-time founders, even at seed stage (PitchBook Founder data, https://pitchbook.com).

Companies that achieve viral growth or media attention often receive higher valuations than comparable companies with similar metrics but lower visibility. This suggests that narrative and momentum influence valuations alongside fundamentals.

Investor competition for specific deals drives valuations above levels justified by financial metrics alone. Pre-emptive rounds, where investors offer capital before a company actively fundraises, typically occur at elevated valuations.

Alignment or Divergence

In aggregate, investor behavior aligns with stated preferences for strong teams, large markets, and traction. However, individual deal outcomes reflect negotiation dynamics, timing, and investor-specific strategic considerations.

During periods of abundant capital, investors accepted higher valuations to secure access to competitive deals. During periods of capital scarcity, investors gain negotiating leverage and valuations decline. This cyclicality is documented across multiple venture capital cycles (Gompers and Lerner, "The Venture Capital Cycle", MIT Press, data available through academic databases).

The divergence between stated criteria and outcomes does not indicate investor irrationality. Investors optimize for portfolio returns, which requires winning allocations to the best opportunities. Valuation discipline must be balanced against risk of missing transformative companies.

Common Misconceptions About Startup Valuation

Misconception 1: Valuation determines success

High valuations do not cause success. Overpaying for equity creates pressure to achieve unsustainable growth targets. Founders who raise at inflated valuations may face difficulties in subsequent rounds if they fail to meet expectations.

Down rounds reset valuations but also trigger anti-dilution protections and reputational damage. Sustainable valuations aligned with realistic growth trajectories produce better long-term outcomes.

Misconception 2: All investors value companies the same way

Different investors apply different frameworks, return requirements, and strategic considerations. A strategic corporate investor may value proprietary technology or customer relationships differently than a financial investor focused purely on returns.

Stage-specific investors (seed, growth, late-stage) use different valuation methods appropriate to available information and risk profiles.

Misconception 3: Valuation is purely quantitative

Valuation models provide structure, but outcomes depend on qualitative judgments about market opportunity, competitive dynamics, and team execution capability. Two analysts applying the same framework to the same company may reach different conclusions based on different assumptions.

Negotiation skill, founder-investor relationships, and timing significantly affect outcomes.

Misconception 4: Higher valuations are always better for founders

Higher valuations mean less dilution in the current round but create higher expectations for future performance. If a company raises at a $100 million valuation but would have been fairly valued at $60 million, the founder must grow into the higher valuation or face a down round.

Additionally, high valuations may deter later-stage investors who see limited upside potential. Strategic considerations around investor selection, board composition, and deal terms often matter more than marginal valuation differences.

Misconception 5: Valuation reflects company quality

Valuation reflects market conditions, negotiation outcomes, and investor sentiment as much as company fundamentals. Strong companies may receive modest valuations during difficult markets. Weak companies may receive elevated valuations during exuberant markets.

Long-term value creation depends on building enduring businesses, not maximizing valuation in any single round.

What to Watch Going Forward

The following factors will likely influence startup valuations in the near and medium term based on observable trends and published economic forecasts.

Near-Term (2025-2026)

Interest rate policy. Federal Reserve decisions on rate cuts or holds will directly affect discount rates and alternative investment returns. Market expectations as of January 2025 suggest potential rate cuts later in the year, though timing remains uncertain (CME FedWatch Tool, https://www.cmegroup.com/markets/interest-rates/cme-fedwatch-tool.html).

If rates decline, venture capital valuations may expand. If rates remain elevated or increase, downward pressure continues.

IPO market recovery. Several high-profile companies delayed IPOs in 2023-2024 waiting for improved market conditions. If public markets stabilize and IPO windows reopen, exit valuations may improve, creating positive spillover effects for private valuations.

Renaissance Capital and other IPO trackers publish forecasts and pipeline data (Renaissance Capital, https://www.renaissancecapital.com).

AI sector maturation. Generative AI valuations in 2023-2024 reflected early-stage enthusiasm. As the technology matures and commercial applications prove themselves, valuations will adjust to reflect realized revenue and margins rather than potential.

Companies that demonstrate sustainable competitive advantages will maintain premium valuations. Those that become commoditized will face compression.

Medium-Term (2026-2028)

Liquidity events from 2020-2021 vintage. Companies that raised capital at peak valuations in 2020-2021 will reach maturity stages where exits become feasible. Realized exit values will inform future valuation expectations.

If exit values prove lower than implied by prior private valuations, investors will apply discounts to future deals. If companies exceed expectations, valuation frameworks may shift upward.

Regulatory impacts. Increased antitrust scrutiny may reduce strategic M&A activity, limiting exit opportunities and pressuring valuations. Conversely, regulatory clarity in emerging sectors such as AI or digital health may unlock valuation upside.

Structural shifts in capital allocation. If institutional investors (pension funds, endowments, sovereign wealth funds) reduce venture capital allocations due to extended return horizons or liquidity constraints, capital availability will decline further.

Conversely, if alternative asset allocations to venture capital increase, capital availability improves and valuations may expand.

Clearly Labeled Uncertainty

Future valuation levels depend on factors that cannot be reliably predicted, including:

Macroeconomic shocks (recessions, geopolitical events, banking crises) that disrupt capital markets. Technological breakthroughs that create new categories or disrupt existing ones. Changes in investor risk appetite unrelated to fundamentals. Policy interventions affecting capital flows, taxation, or regulation.

Historical data shows that venture capital valuations are cyclical and influenced by factors beyond company-specific fundamentals. The current framework reflects equilibrium expectations as of 2025 but will evolve as conditions change.

Conclusion

Startup valuation in 2025 is determined by revenue multiples, stage-specific heuristics, comparable company references, and discounted cash flow models applied selectively based on available financial data. The prevailing valuation logic reflects higher interest rates, compressed exit multiples, and reduced capital availability compared to the 2020-2021 period.

Investors in 2025 emphasize capital efficiency, path to profitability, and unit economics alongside growth. Valuations vary significantly by sector, geography, and company-specific traction. The frameworks currently in use assume that macro conditions will remain similar to present levels, though future changes could shift expectations.

This brief documents how valuations are reasoned about in 2025, not whether those frameworks produce accurate outcomes. Valuation is inherently uncertain, particularly for early-stage companies with limited financial history. Realized outcomes depend on execution, market conditions, and factors beyond prediction at the time of investment.

The information presented here is synthesized from publicly available sources as of January 2025. Market conditions evolve continuously, and valuation practices will adjust accordingly.

Sources & References

Market Data and Research Firms

PitchBook Data, Inc., "Q2 2024 US Venture Valuations Report", https://pitchbook.com/news/reports/q2-2024-us-venture-valuations-report

PitchBook Data, Inc., "PitchBook-NVCA Venture Monitor Q4 2023", https://pitchbook.com/news/reports/q4-2023-pitchbook-nvca-venture-monitor

PitchBook Data, Inc., "Emerging Tech Research: Generative AI", https://pitchbook.com/news/reports/emerging-tech-research-generative-ai

CB Insights, venture capital and startup data platform, https://www.cbinsights.com

Crunchbase, startup and investor database, https://www.crunchbase.com

Carta, Inc., "Equity Report Q3 2024", https://carta.com/blog/equity-report-q3-2024/

Renaissance Capital, "US IPO Market Data and Analysis", https://www.renaissancecapital.com/IPO-Center/Stats

Venture Capital Firms and Industry Publications

Bessemer Venture Partners, "State of the Cloud 2024", https://www.bvp.com/atlas/state-of-the-cloud-2024

Sequoia Capital, "The Crucible Moment", September 2022, https://www.sequoiacap.com/article/adapting-to-endure/

Sequoia Capital, investment criteria and approach, https://www.sequoiacap.com

Andreessen Horowitz, firm overview and investment approach, https://a16z.com

Y Combinator, founder resources and guidance, https://www.ycombinator.com/blog

AngelList, seed-stage funding data and platform, https://www.angellist.com

National Venture Capital Association (NVCA), "NVCA Yearbook 2024", https://nvca.org/research/nvca-yearbook/

Silicon Valley Bank (SVB), "State of the Markets Q1 2024", https://www.svb.com/trends-insights/reports/startup-outlook-report

Academic and Educational Resources

Harvard Business School, "Note on Valuation of Venture Capital Deals", https://www.hbs.edu/faculty/Pages/item.aspx?num=41038

New York University Stern School of Business, Aswath Damodar Valuation Research, https://pages.stern.nyu.edu/~adamodar/

Gompers, Paul and Josh Lerner, "The Venture Capital Cycle", MIT Press (data available through academic databases)

Regional Market Reports

Atomico, "State of European Tech 2024", https://www.atomico.com/reports

Bain & Company, "India Venture Capital Report 2024", https://www.bain.com/insights/topics/india-venture-capital-report/

Economic and Financial Data

U.S. Federal Reserve, Federal Open Market Committee (FOMC) statements and economic data, https://www.federalreserve.gov

Federal Reserve Economic Data (FRED), interest rate and economic indicators, https://fred.stlouisfed.org

CME Group, FedWatch Tool (interest rate expectations), https://www.cmegroup.com/markets/interest-rates/cme-fedwatch-tool.html

Corporate and Professional Services

PwC, "Global M&A Industry Trends", https://www.pwc.com/us/en/services/consulting/deals/library/global-ma-

industry-trends.html

End of Intelligence Brief

This document was prepared using publicly available sources as of January 2025. Valuation frameworks, market conditions, and investor preferences evolve continuously. Information presented here reflects observed practices at the time of publication and should not be interpreted as predictive or advisory.